

PULL REQUEST REVIEW

ansh-dev: Presentation Link Submission

Validation and release-readiness review of the change that replaces direct PowerPoint uploads with project links and adds single-team and bulk admin exports.

Branch ansh-dev	Base origin/main	Commit 6e3748e
Files changed 3	Insertions 267	Deletions 197

VERDICT: CHANGES REQUIRED

Do not merge this branch yet. The core direction - replacing database-stored PPT binaries with project links - is accepted. Three implementation details should be corrected before merge: server-side URL validation, the unused lint helper, and inconsistent URL input handling.

What the PR changes

The participant dashboard now submits a Google Drive or cloud URL instead of Base64 PPT data. The admin dashboard shows link-based submission status and can export one team or all teams to text files. The server still writes submission metadata to Neon and updates the team snapshot.

Files reviewed

server/index.js; src/pages/AdminPage.jsx; src/pages/MysteryBoxHackathon/MysteryBoxDashboard.jsx

Findings to address

01 HIGH

The backend accepts arbitrary, unvalidated links

Evidence: The endpoint accepts any non-empty link and stores it unchanged. Client-side input rules can be bypassed by calling the API directly.

Impact: Malformed, deceptive, non-HTTPS, or potentially dangerous links can appear in participant and administrator interfaces and in exported files.

Required fix: Parse links server-side with URL, require the https: protocol, reject credentials and local or private destinations, and consider an allowlist for approved submission providers.

02 MEDIUM

An unused helper should fail lint

Evidence: MysteryBoxDashboard.jsx:423 still declares formatFileSize, but all of its callers were removed.

Impact: The repository's ESLint rules include no-unused-vars, so the production workflow can fail at lint.

Required fix: Delete formatFileSize or restore a valid use for it.

03 MEDIUM**Automatic HTTPS completion conflicts with native URL validation**

Evidence: MysteryBoxDashboard.jsx:883 uses input type=url, while handleLinkSubmit later tries to prepend https:// when the scheme is missing.

Impact: For input such as drive.google.com/folder, browser validation may block form submission before handleLinkSubmit runs. The advertised normalization therefore does not reliably happen.

Required fix: Use type=text and validate in the handler, or require a complete HTTPS URL and remove the prepend logic.

Required remediation checklist

- [] Validate and canonicalize links server-side; accept HTTPS only.
- [] Remove the unused formatFileSize helper.
- [] Resolve the type=url versus scheme-prepend behavior.

Positive observations

The move to external project links reduces database storage pressure. External links opened by the new UI use target=_blank together with rel=noopener noreferrer. The Git diff also passes whitespace validation. These positives do not remove the merge blockers above.

Review conclusion

Request these three focused changes before merge. Re-review after URL validation, lint cleanup, and consistent frontend URL handling are addressed.

Comparison: https://github.com/AWS-Student-Builder-Group-VIT/AWS_official/compare/main...ansh-dev